

ReclaimKit - Auto Email Setup

ReclaimKit contributors

Auto-email setup (free Gmail)

Send Meta GDPR letters automatically from your VPS — **free** using a Gmail account and an **App Password**.

What auto-email does: Sends escalation letters **to** `privacy@facebook.com` on schedule.

What it does NOT do: Read Meta's replies from your inbox. When Meta emails you back, check Gmail yourself and run the matching CLI command (see [When Meta replies](#)).

What gets automated

Automated	Manual
Daily monitor + Slack alerts	Reading Meta's reply emails
Generate next letter after 7 days silence	Pasting Google form submissions
Optional: SMTP send to Meta	Recording campaign refused if Meta says no
Attach screenshots from <code>evidence/screenshots/</code>	Sending passport/ID if Meta asks

Enable in `config.yaml` :

```
automation:
  enabled: true
  auto_escalate: true
  meta_escalation_days: 7
  auto_send_emails: true      # turn ON after SMTP tested
  smtp:
    enabled: true
    host: smtp.gmail.com
    port: 587
    use_tls: true
    username: your.name@gmail.com
    from_email: your.name@gmail.com
    password: ""              # use .env - see below
```

Step 1 — Use a dedicated Gmail address

1. Create **your.name.reclaim@gmail.com** (or use existing Gmail)
2. Use the **same address** in `config.yaml` → `subject.email` and `smtp.from_email`
3. Meta replies go to this inbox — check it weekly

Free: Gmail costs nothing. No paid SMTP service required.

Step 2 — Create a Google App Password

Google blocks normal passwords for SMTP. You need a 16-character **App Password**.

1. Enable **2-Step Verification** on the Google account:
<https://myaccount.google.com/security>
2. Go to **App passwords**:
<https://myaccount.google.com/apppasswords>
3. Create app: name it `ReclaimKit VPS`
4. Copy the 16-character password (e.g. `abcd efgh ijkl mnop`)

Step 3 — Store password securely (not in config.yaml)

```
cp .env.example .env
nano .env
```

```
RECLAIMKIT_SMTP_PASSWORD=abcdefghijklmnop # no spaces
RECLAIMKIT_SLACK_WEBHOOK=https://hooks.slack.com/...
```

Load before running:

```
export $(grep -v '^#' .env | xargs)
```

On Docker VPS, uncomment in `deploy/docker-compose.yml` :

```
env_file:
- ../.env
```

`src/config.py` injects `RECLAIMKIT_SMTP_PASSWORD` into `automation.smtp.password` automatically.

Step 4 — Send Round 1 manually first

Auto-email only sends **escalation rounds** after Round 1 is recorded. Always:

```
python3 main.py campaign init
# Email Round 1 yourself OR test SMTP once manually
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1
```

Step 5 — Test SMTP before enabling automation

Create a one-line test (from repo root):

```
export $(grep -v '^#' .env | xargs)
python3 -c "
from src.config import load_config
from src.email_sender import send_letter_email
cfg = load_config('config.yaml')
cfg['automation']['smtp']['enabled'] = True
r = send_letter_email(
    cfg,
    to_address='privacy@facebook.com',
    subject='TEST - ignore - ReclaimKit SMTP check',
    body='SMTP test only. Please ignore.',
    attach_screenshots=False,
)
print(r)
"
```

Expected: `{'sent': True, ...}`

If it fails: - Check App Password (no spaces in `.env`) - Check 2-Step Verification enabled - Try port 587 + `use_tls: true`

Step 6 — Enable auto-send on VPS

```
# config.yaml
automation:
  auto_send_emails: true
  smtp:
    enabled: true

cd deploy && docker compose up -d --build
```

Daily cron runs `python3 main.py daemon` once which: 1. Monitors Google for your name 2. After 7 days since last send → generates next Meta letter 3. If `auto_send_emails: true` → emails `privacy@facebook.com` 4. Records send in `output/campaign/state.json` 5. Slack notification

Logs: `output/cron.log` , `output/automation-log.jsonl`

When Meta replies (you still act)

ReclaimKit **cannot read your Gmail inbox** (by design — safer, simpler).

When Meta emails you:

Meta says	You run
“Content removed”	<code>python3 main.py campaign success</code>
“Does not violate...” / refusal	<code>python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "paste their reply"</code>
“We need ID”	Reply manually with passport — do not automate
“Received your request”	Wait — no action yet
No reply after 7 days	Daemon auto-escalates OR <code>python3 main.py campaign no-response --track meta</code>

Tip: Create a Gmail filter: from `facebook.com` OR `meta.com` → label `ReclaimKit` → star.

Alternative free SMTP providers

Provider	SMTP host	Notes
Gmail	<code>smtp.gmail.com:587</code>	Recommended — App Password
Outlook.com	<code>smtp-mail.outlook.com:587</code>	App password if 2FA on
Proton Mail	Paid bridge required	Not free for SMTP

Security checklist

- ☐ App Password only — never your main Google password
- ☐ `.env` in `.gitignore` (already is)

- ☐ VPS SSH keys only
- ☐ `auto_send_emails: false` until SMTP test passes
- ☐ Same email in `subject.email` and `smtp.from_email`

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
SMTP disabled	Set <code>automation.smtp.enabled: true</code>
Incomplete SMTP config	Fill username, from_email, RECLAIMKIT_SMTP_PASSWORD
535 Authentication failed	Regenerate App Password
Email sent but no Meta reply	Normal — wait up to 1 month GDPR deadline
Auto-send didn't fire	Check <code>campaign sent</code> recorded; need 7+ days since last send

Run: `python3 main.py doctor` and `./scripts/audit.sh`